

Swift to Hear listening practice

Note for the Christadelphian Support Network, August 2026

The problem

In ecclesial conversation, especially on sensitive subjects, we often speak past one another or answer before we have heard. Modern media have trained us to be more reactive, more polarising and less able to listen. A simple listening practice already exists to help with this. It uses three rotating roles in a group of three:

- **Speaker:** shares what is on their heart, with time to think aloud.
- **Listener:** reflects back what they heard, without advice or a counter-argument.
- **Scribe:** writes down the main points so they are not lost.

The practice is written up as a PDF. However, ordinary paper and standard card are not durable enough for something meant to be reused and passed hand to hand between groups.

Suggested solution

Print the practice on board-game board (253mm x 179mm, between A5 and A4). This lasts better than card and is cheaper than Foamex. Each pack would be a set of six boards. Mailing it out to ecclesias would get the practice into the hands of Brothers and Sisters to practise in small groups.

If adopted, the practice can:

- slow conversation so people are heard before anyone answers
- guard against reactivity and debate (the listener reflects rather than replies)
- stop one person dominating, because the roles rotate
- keep insights from being lost, through the scribe
- build trust, so correction can be received more gently
- help people notice weak reasoning as ideas are drawn out
- let ideas be tested in a small group before they reach a wider audience
- give a careful way into sensitive subjects, once the process is familiar

Costs

Quantity of boards	Cost per board	Cost per set of 6
25	£5.15	£30.90
100-249	£3.10	£18.60
249-400	£2.85	£17.10

25 sets of 6 = £465. 50 sets of 6 = £855. The more you print, the cheaper each unit is.

These costs are for voluntary, no-cost training of groups, not for private business.

For more info and video explainers: swifttohear.web.app/christadelphian